

respiratory system

larynx

Muscular cartilaginous duct at the upper terminal part of the trachea; it contains the vocal cords and plays a role in speech and respiration.

epiglottis

Movable cartilaginous plate ensuring that the larynx closes during ingestion of food so that food cannot enter the respiratory tract.

hyoid bone

Bone supporting the larynx, and the insertion point for various muscles of the tongue, pharynx, and larynx.

thyrohyoid membrane

Membrane linking thyroid cartilage to the hyoid bone.

thyroid cartilage

Structure formed of two lateral plates whose junction forms a very visible ridge in men (Adam's apple).

cricoid cartilage

Ring-shaped structure located in the lower larynx.

trachea

Muscular cartilaginous tract that is a continuation of the larynx; it divides into two main bronchi, each of which ends in a lung, and allows air to pass.

